SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #45 · GOD'S PROVISION

"Worrying about money shows I'm being responsible."

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Where it often comes from

Worry can feel like a form of caring. If we stop worrying, we fear we will stop paying attention. Parents who fretted about money may have modeled it as the mark of a serious person, and sometimes worry did seem to get things done. Over time, the habit can become automatic and exhausting.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus asks, "Who of you by worrying can add a single hour to his life?" and tells us, "Do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself." Paul says, "Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus." Peter says, "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you." Responsibility is planning, budgeting, and acting. Worry does none of these.

> *"Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus"* (Philippians 4:6–7).

Also see

> "Who of you by worrying can add a single hour to his life?" (Matthew 6:27).

> "Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own" (Matthew 6:34).

> "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you" (1 Peter 5:7).

> "The plans of the diligent bring plenty, as surely as haste leads to poverty" (Proverbs 21:5).

Common self-statements

- If I stop worrying, I will get careless.
- Worrying keeps me prepared.
- Good providers lose sleep over money.
- Relaxing about money is irresponsible.
- I have to think about it constantly.
- Worry shows I care.

Common logical errors

- Magical thinking: Believing worry prevents bad outcomes.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must either worry or be careless.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining worst-case outcomes repeatedly.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should feel anxious to prove I care.

Challenging questions

- Has worrying ever solved a money problem, or did actions solve it?

- What is the difference between worrying and planning?
- Who modeled money worry for me?
- What does Jesus say worry can add?
- What action steps could replace worry about this problem?
- What would it look like to pray and plan instead of worry?

Truth summary

> Worry is not the same as responsibility. Planning, budgeting, and acting are responsible, and I can do them with prayer and thanksgiving instead of anxiety. God's peace can guard my heart while I take wise steps.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anxiety/Worry
- Peace
- Thinking, Healthy
- Plans
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anxiety/Worry/Fear
- Money/Riches

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Worrying about money shows I'm being responsible"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Worrying about money shows I'm being responsible." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Has worry ever solved a money problem?
- ☐ What is the difference between worry and planning?
- ☐ Who modeled worry for me?
- ☐ What action can I take?
- ☐ What request can I bring to God?
- ☐ What am I thankful for?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Worry adds nothing to my life.
- ☐ Planning is responsible, worry is not.
- ☐ I can pray and plan.
- ☐ God's peace guards my heart and mind.
- ☐ I can cast my anxiety on Him.
- ☐ Today has enough trouble of its own.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Philippians 4:6–7
  "Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ Matthew 6:34
  "Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own."
- ☐ 1 Peter 5:7
  "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Worry to action: Each time you worry about money, write one action step you can take and one request you will bring to God.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Philippians 4:6–7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can pray and plan, and God's peace will guard my heart.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Anxiety/Worry" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ Set a worry time. Give yourself 15 minutes a day to think about money, then set it down.
- ☐ Write the action steps. Turn each worry into a specific task with a date.
- ☐ Pray with thanksgiving. Present one request to God and name one thing you are thankful for.
- ☐ Memorize Philippians 4:6–7. Say it when worry returns.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Worrying about money shows I'm being responsible": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Worry turned to action
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Worrying about money shows I'm being responsible.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I confuse worry with responsibility. Teach me to plan wisely and to bring my requests to You with thanksgiving. Let Your peace guard my heart and mind. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.